with international audiences contrasts with what are sometimes erratic performances on the local stage. The NLD makes no apology for this elitism or the advanced age of its senior decision-makers (for context see Farrelly 2016). They are the product of a long-running struggle for greater democratic participation in politics. The harsh reality, for these top leaders, is that their recent electoral success has revealed just how much work still needs to be done.

RELIGION

Perhaps the most demanding challenge in Myanmar today is the social faultline between Muslims and Buddhists. Muslims make up at least four per cent of the population although some guess that the actual proportion is nowadays much higher (see discussion in Crouch 2016, pp. 10–12). Such are the sensitivities around religious adherence that the government has proved reluctant to release the relevant parts of the 2014 census. The unspoken fear is that an accurate count of Myanmar's Muslims will further inflame the simmering resentments felt by many Buddhists. While there is a treasured local tradition of tolerance for different faiths, anti-Muslim sentiments also have a long history (Kipgen 2013). Under the Thein Sein government, the situation deteriorated greatly, particularly in northern Rakhine State, home to the persecuted Rohingya. Anti-Muslim violence in 2012 entrenched the divisions between Myanmar's two largest faith communities, and focused attention on the spiteful rhetoric of nationalist politicians and monks. In this volume, both Wells and Schissler look at the resulting challenges. In the years since that spike in violence, Muslims have struggled to protect their previous status and many Rohingya have been forced to live hand-to-mouth in informal settlements. Others have sought sanctuary across the border in Bangladesh, as explored in this volume's chapter by Khan.

Under these conditions, even the term "Rohingya" is contested. Those who seek to extinguish its usage on Myanmar soil claim that the designation hides illegal immigrants from Bangladesh who should be expelled from Myanmar territory. Myanmar's own official scheme of categorisation, which encompasses 135 ethnicities, includes one group that is predominately Muslim, the Kaman. They also live in Rakhine State and have been caught up in the recent religious conflicts. By the end of 2012, the violence had displaced over 140,000 Muslims, including Rohingya and Kaman. This